

Friday, 29 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

27° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

24° 16°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

22° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Scotland's First Minister John Swinney has turned down calls for a Holyrood inquiry into former SNP chief executive Peter Murrell.

This comes after Mr Murrell admitted embezzling over £400,000 from the party. Opponents are now demanding a full investigation into the financial scandal.

POLITICS · UK

2

One of the UK's most famous, and perhaps rudest, chalk figures is getting a much-needed refresh to stop it fading away.

National Trust staff and volunteers are applying a whopping seventeen tonnes of fresh chalk to the Cerne Abbas Giant in Dorset. It's all to preserve the historic landmark from the British weather.

HERITAGE · UK

3

A teenage girl has bravely shared her story with BBC Newsnight after being raped by teenage boys, revealing her ongoing fear.

She is now experiencing flashbacks and lives in constant dread of encountering her attackers. Her testimony highlights the lasting trauma faced by survivors.

SOCIETY · UK

What's coming up

1 A new discussion is opening up about the future of hardback books, asking if they're still a thing of beauty or a dying art.

Publishers, readers, and libraries are all weighing in on whether the traditional hardback can survive in the digital age. It's a fascinating look at how we consume stories.

BOOKS · FUTURE

2 The actor who played Dani Rojas in Ted Lasso, Cristo Fernández, is set to swap the fictional pitch for a real-life professional football career in the US.

He's just signed with a US pro team, calling it a "dream come true." Fans will be keen to see if his on-screen skills translate to the actual game.

TV · WHAT'S NEXT

3 There's a lot of buzz around a new "raucous" debut novel, promising readers an epic night out all contained within its pages.

The author, Sufiyaan Salam, is already making waves, having previously won an award from Stormzy and been nominated for a Bafta. This highly anticipated book is expected to be a big talking point.

BOOKS · NEW RELEASE

On the schedule

- 1 Manchester United are reportedly prioritising new central midfield signings this summer, with Michael Carrick at the helm.**
The club is looking to fill a gap in their squad, potentially addressing the very area Carrick himself excelled in as a player. Fans will be watching closely to see who arrives at Old Trafford.
FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 The Premier League will again have a record nine teams competing in Europe, which could have some interesting knock-on effects domestically.**
This large contingent means fixture congestion and squad rotation will be key factors for many clubs. It might even indirectly affect smaller teams like York City, impacting player loans and league schedules.
FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Tennis legend Serena Williams could be making a highly anticipated return to competitive action at the Queen's Club next month.**
She's reportedly in talks about playing at the prestigious London tournament. Fans will be eager to see if she graces the grass courts once again.
TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

1 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.

Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.

2 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.

Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.

3 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.

The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.

4 The most-Googleed DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.

Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.

5 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.

Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.

6 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.

Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.

7 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.

Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 48% of us do **THIS** every single day. What is it?
ANSWER: STEP ON THE BATHROOM SCALES.

Q 63% of us have done **THIS** in a meeting we're meant to be paying attention to. What?
ANSWER: ONLINE SHOPPING.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers say the most stressful day to drive in the UK isn't Monday — it's THIS day.**
(Spoiler: it's Thursday.) Talk-back: what day of the week feels longest to you, and why?
- **The 'big shop' is dying — younger Brits are doing 4–6 small shops a week instead.**
Talk-back: are you a one-big-shop person or a daily-corner-shop person? And which one is your partner?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Sport.** A grassroots football club in the Lake District plays its home games on a pitch with a 1-in-12 slope at one end — the steepest legal gradient for organised football.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A 5-a-side league in Slough has banned all 'celebration sliding' after three players in one season tore their shorts and demanded refunds.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The plastic bits on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Penguins propose to their mates by giving them a pebble.
- Strawberries aren't actually berries, but bananas, watermelons and pumpkins are.
- Cats have a special collarbone that lets them always land on their feet — usually.
- The word 'set' has the most definitions of any word in the English language — 430.
- The longest English word without a vowel is 'rhythms'.
- Ketchup was sold in the 1830s as medicine.
- Hippos secrete their own natural sunscreen — a reddish, oily substance.

On this day

Day 149 of the year, 216 days left in 2026. Today Army Day (Argentina); Ascension of Bahá'u'lláh (Bahá'í Faith) (Only if Bahá'í Naw-Rúz falls on March 21 of the Gregorian calendar); Christian feast day: Bona of Pisa; Christian feast day: Hypomone (Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1956 — La Toya Jackson, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1959 — Mel Gaynor, English drummer
- 1954 — Robert Beaser, American composer and educator
- 1926 — Katie Boyle, Italian-English actress and television host (died 2018)
- 1947 — Anthony Geary, American actor (died 2025)
- 1967 — Noel Gallagher, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1923 — Eugene Wright, American jazz bassist (died 2020)
- 1942 — Kevin Conway, American actor and director (died 2020)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2022 — Tara Air Flight 197 crashes in Nepal's Mustang District, killing 22.
- 1962 — Chinese police open fire on protesters in Yining, Xinjiang, killing at least five people and wounding a dozen others.
- 1964 — Having deposed them in a January coup South Vietnamese leader Nguyễn Khánh had rival Generals Trần Văn Đôn and Lê Văn Kim convicted of "lax morality".

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1999 — Space Shuttle Discovery completes the first docking with the International Space Station.
- 1990 — The Congress of People's Deputies of Russia elects Boris Yeltsin as President of the Russian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Tom Bradley is elected the first black mayor of Los Angeles, California.
- 2004 — The National World War II Memorial is dedicated in Washington, D.C.

- 1993 — The Miss Sarajevo beauty pageant is held in war-torn Sarajevo drawing global attention to the plight of its citizens.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 150 of the year, 215 days left in 2026. Today Anguilla Day, commemorates the beginning of the Anguillian Revolution in 1967. (Anguilla); Canary Islands Day (Spain); Christian feast day: Basil the Elder and Emmelia of Caesarea; Christian feast day: Dymphna. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — CeeLo Green, American singer-songwriter
- 1952 — Daniel Grodnik, American screenwriter and producer
- 1939 — Michael J. Pollard, American actor (died 2019)
- 1961 — John Terlesky, American actor
- 1939 — Tim Waterstone, Scottish businessman, founded Waterstones
- 1964 — Wynonna Judd, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1953 — Colm Meaney, Irish actor
- 1971 — Duncan Jones, English director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2008 — TACA Flight 390 overshoots the runway at Toncontin International Airport in Tegucigalpa, Honduras and crashes, killing five people.
- 1999 — 53 people are killed in a stampede at the Nyamiha metro station in Minsk, Belarus.
- 1975 — European Space Agency is established.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2003 — Depayin massacre: At least 70 people associated with the National League for Democracy are killed by government-sponsored mob in Burma. Aung San Suu Kyi flees the scene, but is arrested soon afterwards.
- 1998 — Nuclear Testing: Pakistan conducts an underground test in the Kharan Desert. It is reported to be a plutonium device with yield of 20kt TNT equivalent.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		